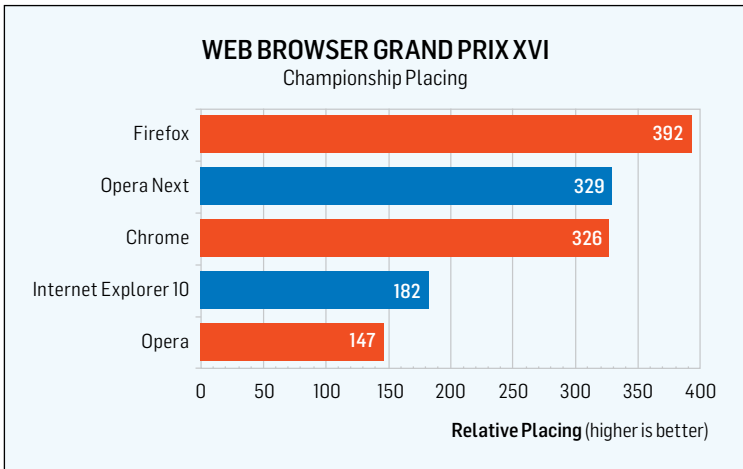




the ‘modern browser’ race, and pioneered extensions on a browser platform. Having pioneered the concept of extensibility to a browser’s experience, Firefox paved the way (along with many other developments, of course) for ushering us into the new-age era of apps and smart-everything. Now, in principle if not always in reality, it’s hard to miss the similarities between a modern web browser and the mobile ecosystem. In fact, Google has taken this very approach and developed and deployed the Chrome OS on the Chromebooks that it has started selling as low-spec internet laptops.

Since we can’t continue to bask in the glory of the past, it can only mean a direct head-to-head between the best and latest browsers. While WebKit, being a newly built engine, enjoys the benefit of having a streamlined code-base for now, expect that advantage to diminish as time goes by. Numerous tests have been performed to test the allegedly ‘ageing’ Firefox against its new competitors, and judging from results by a rather reliable source in Tom’s Hardware, we can see that after a few years of dormancy, Firefox has risen up again to take the lead, in the benchmarks at least.

Of course, browser wars are not the bloodiest battles, and most breakthroughs have a way of finding themselves with either camp in a reasonably short span of time. While the makers may fight it out to gain that fraction of a performance boost, it can only be a win-win for the consumer, who gets to witness the latest and the greatest that some of the best minds can conjure up. 